	STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE State Form 39870(R/S-06)	Reference Number CPS-007
	Subject Capitol Police Section – Explosive Detection Canines	
	Special Instructions New	Effective Date **August 4, 2025**

I. PURPOSE

Establish guidelines and procedures for the utilization and training of Capitol Police Section (CPS) Explosive Detection Canines (EDC) and handlers.

II. POLICY

Capitol Police Section handlers shall always maintain control of their canine and meet all certification and recertification requirements. Canines shall be utilized during normal shift duties, special details, and to assist other agencies as needed. During Explosive Ordinance Detection (EOD) details, the canine team shall report to the Special Operations Commander (SOC) or designee.

Handlers shall have final authority for all operational decisions concerning the safety and utilization of the canine. Section canines shall not be utilized or required to operate outside the scope of their training.

III. PROCEDURE

A. Capitol Police canine teams shall be used within the scope of their training for:

1. The detection of explosives and/or explosive devices.

2. Conducting routine security checks of State properties and operated facilities.

3. Conducting mail checks and facilitating the processing of questionable packages, envelopes, and articles.

4. Responding for the Unknown Substance Response Group (USRG) for the Government Center Complex and other State facilities.

5. Participating in public relations programs and demonstrations

6. Providing other agencies with explosive detection sweeps and/or protective sweeps, as needed.

7. Responding as requested by the SOC or designee.

B. In addition to maintaining any canine required certification, EDC handlers should maintain proficiency, skills, and knowledge in:

1. Basic gamma radiation detection using a Personal Radiation Detector (PRD);
2. Explosive Ordnance Reconnaissance tasks; and
3. Unknown Substance Response Group (USRG).

C. Selection of Canine Handlers

1. EDC handler positions shall be opened and assigned to serve the needs of the Department.

2. Candidates for an EDC handler positions shall:

a. Be a CPS Officer(s);
b. Meet the guidelines set forth in SOC-004 (Assignment/Membership to Specialty Teams);
c. Meet the selection criteria outlined in SOC-005 (Canine Training and Utilization); and
d. Meet the requirements of SOC-007 (Explosive Ordnance Disposal Team Personnel).

3. Selection of CPS EDC handlers shall be made by the CPS Major upon recommendation from the applicable interview board, with final approval of the Superintendent.

D. Canine Handler Training

1.CPS EDC handlers shall be properly trained and utilized in accordance with the approved training association or organization standards and the standards set forth in the Explosive Detection Canine Manual.

2. EDC teams will complete an initial training program to include certification, and annual recertification.

3. CPS EDC handlers, once selected, have one year to complete the basic Explosive Ordinance Reconnaissance (EOR) in accordance with SOC-007.

4. EDC teams must attend monthly K9 in-service, as well as EOD monthly in-service and EOD Annual training.

5. Acquiring and storing explosives for canine training.

a. Handlers will obtain and maintain an Explosive Detection Canine training kit for canine training purposes from the EOD Commander or designee.

b. EOD guidelines shall be followed concerning the storage, use, inventory, audits, and destruction of explosives.

c. An inventory sheet shall be maintained by the handler and available for review upon request.

E. Maintenance and Kenneling

1. Handlers shall be assigned an adequate kennel and lock, for their residence, to ensure the safety and security of the dog.

2. The kennel is the property of the Department.

3. The canine will be secured in the kennel when not under the immediate control of the handler.

4. Handlers shall be authorized one hour (1.0) during each duty shift for canine maintenance.

5. Overtime for canine maintenance for time off shall follow HMR-008.

6. Should the handler become ill, on vacation, or otherwise unable to provide maintenance and training of their canine, the Training Division K9 Coordinator or designee, shall be contacted by the handler, or supervisor, to provide approved kenneling of the canine, until the handler returns to duty or is able to care for the canine.

F. Canine Veterinary Care

1. Handlers agree to provide appropriate veterinary care to their assigned canine, at a minimum, to include:

a. Annual veterinary examination;
b. Rabies vaccination (yearly or every three years);
c. Yearly heartworm testing;
d. Year-round heartworm preventative;
e. Flea and tick preventative

2. Handlers should seek veterinary care if their canine is exhibiting any signs of:

a. Emergency;
b. Distress;
c. Injury;
d. Extended periods of:

(i) Vomiting;
(ii) Diarrhea;
(iii) Blood in stool or urine;
(iv) Lethargy;
(v) Lack of appetite; or
(vi) Refusal to drink water.

3. Handlers may seek veterinary care in other circumstances as needed after seeking approval from the Training Division K9 Coordinator.

4. Handlers shall utilize an ISP recommended veterinarian, unless an emergency necessitates other veterinary care.

5. The Department shall be responsible for veterinary fees for canine care. A SOJ shall be submitted through RMS for reimbursement for canine veterinary care expenses.

G. This SOP is to be used in conjunction with all relevant Department regulations, rules, policies, and procedures.